

Appletree Interiors ERP — Standard Operating Procedure

A practical, day-to-day guide for every Appletree team member who uses the ERP.

DOCUMENT	VERSION	STATUS
Appletree ERP SOP	1.0	Final
PREPARED FOR	OWNER	REVIEW
Appletree Interiors	Appletree Management / ERP Admin	Update when the ERP or a process changes

Purpose: to help every Appletree employee use the ERP correctly, every day. **Scope:** this handbook covers only the features that genuinely exist in the current ERP, verified against the system itself — not a wish-list, not a plan.

PART 1

About the ERP

The Appletree ERP is the one system where every project, customer, purchase, material movement, and rupee is recorded – from the first phone call with a customer to the final payment on a completed project. It replaces scattered notebooks, WhatsApp quotations, and separate Excel sheets with one shared record everyone can trust.

It covers the full life of an interior project: **Sales** (leads, quotations), **Procurement** (purchase orders, supplier bills), **Inventory** (plywood, laminate, hardware – what's in the factory store and what's gone to site), **Project costing** (labour, expenses, profitability), **Accounting** (GST, ledgers, payments), and **After-Sales** (service and AMC).

WHY IT MATTERS

Every number in this ERP – a quotation value, a stock count, a customer's outstanding balance – is only correct if it is entered correctly and on time. This handbook exists so every team member enters things the same, correct way.

PART 2

Who Uses the ERP

Ten types of ERP users exist today. Each one logs in with their own username and only sees and does what their role allows.

ROLE	TYPICALLY
Admin	ERP administrator — sets up masters, users, and system configuration
CEO	Full visibility and approval authority across the business
Finance Manager	Approves and posts financial transactions, manages payments
Accountant	Enters day-to-day accounting entries, prepares documents for approval
Purchase	Raises purchase orders, receives goods, manages vendors
Sales	Manages leads and customers, prepares quotations
Estimator	Prepares costing for quotations
Project Manager	Oversees assigned projects and their progress
Site In-Charge	Manages material and labour at the actual project site
Viewer	Read-only access — for someone who needs to see information but not change it

Part 3 explains what each of these roles can actually do, in detail.

PART 3

Roles and Responsibilities

This table is the real, current permission list built into the ERP — not a guess. If a box below says a role **cannot** do something, the ERP itself will refuse it, no matter who asks.

ROLE	VIEW	CREATE	EDIT	SUBMIT	APPROVE	POST	REVERSE	CLEAR RECEIPTS	PAY	
Admin	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
CEO	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
Finance Manager	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
Accountant	✓	✓	✓	✓	—	—	—	✓	—	
Purchase	✓	✓	✓	✓	—	—	—	—	—	
Sales	✓	✓	✓	✓	—	—	—	—	—	
Estimator	✓	✓	✓	✓	—	—	—	—	—	
Project Manager	✓	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	
Site In-Charge	✓	✓	✓	✓	—	—	—	—	—	
Viewer	✓	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	

READ THIS CAREFULLY

"Create" and "Submit" are not the same as "final." A Sales or Purchase user can create and submit a document, but a Finance Manager, CEO, or Admin must approve/post many of them before they count as final accounting. See Part 21 for what Draft → Approved → Posted actually means.

Project Manager is view-only in the ERP today — a PM sees their assigned projects' full detail (cost, progress, materials) but does not create or edit transactions directly; the Site In-Charge, Purchase, or Accountant records the actual entries.

A closer, per-module breakdown of what each role can and cannot do is in Part 31.

PART 4

Login and Basic Navigation

- 1 Open the ERP link given to you by your Admin and enter **username** and **password** .
your

2 If you enter the wrong password five times in a row, your account will be temporarily locked. Wait and try again, or ask your Admin to unlock it.

3 Once logged in, you will only see the menus and screens your role is allowed to use.

4 Always log out when you finish, especially on a shared computer.

SECURITY

Never share your password with a colleague, even a senior one. Every action in the ERP is recorded against your own login (Part 30). If someone else uses your login, any mistake — or any approval — is recorded as yours.

PART 5

Master Data

Master data is the standing information the ERP reuses on every transaction — your customer list, vendor list, material list, and so on. Getting master data right the first time saves everyone trouble later.

Customers

Every customer must exist in the ERP before you can quote or bill them. Typically created by **Sales** or **Admin**.

FIELD **Customer Name**

The customer's full name or company name, exactly as it should appear on invoices.

FIELD **GSTIN**

The customer's GST number, entered exactly as shown on their own documents. Optional — leave blank if the customer has none. **Do not enter another customer's GST number.** The ERP will not let you register the same GSTIN twice under two different customer names.

FIELD **Active**

Whether this customer is currently usable for new transactions. A customer can be deactivated instead of deleted, so their history is never lost.

Duplicate check: the ERP checks new customer names and GST numbers against existing customers so the same real customer is not accidentally registered twice under two slightly different names.

Vendors (Suppliers)

Created by **Purchase** or **Admin**, e.g. *ABC Plywood Suppliers, XYZ Hardware Traders, Kerala Glass & Aluminium.*

FIELD **Vendor Name**

The supplier's business name.

FIELD **GST Number**

Same rule as customer GSTIN – exact, and never shared between two different vendors.

FIELD **Category**

What this vendor supplies – e.g. Panel/Board, Hardware, Glass/Aluminium – for grouping vendors on reports.

Materials

Every plywood sheet, laminate sheet, hinge, or hardware item you buy, store, or issue must exist as a material record first – created by **Purchase** or **Admin**.

FIELD **Code**

A short unique code, e.g. **PLY18** for 18mm Marine Plywood. The ERP will not allow a second material with the same code.

FIELD **Description**

The full name, e.g. "Plywood 18mm Marine Grade." The ERP also blocks a second material with an identical description, even under a different code – this catches accidental duplicates.

FIELD UOM (Unit of Measure)

How this material is counted – sheet, piece, box, etc.

FIELD Standard Cost

Your expected/reference cost per unit, used for cost estimation. Must be zero or a positive number – the ERP will reject a negative cost or a typo that isn't a real number.

FIELD Tax Code

Which GST rate normally applies to this material (see Part 22).

COMMON MISTAKE

Do not create a new material every time you buy the "same" plywood from a different supplier. One material = one real item, regardless of which vendor supplies it this time.

Other masters

MASTER	WHAT IT IS	WHO CREATES IT
GL Accounts	The Chart of Accounts your accountant posts to (Bank, AR, AP, Revenue, etc.)	Admin only
Tax Codes	GST rate combinations – see Part 22	Admin only
Cost Centres	Groups costs by department/function, e.g. Factory, Installation	Admin only
Profit Centres	Groups revenue/profit by business area	Admin only
Projects	Every customer project – see Part 9	Sales/Admin (via Won Quotation) or Admin directly
Warehouses	Physical stock locations, e.g. "Main Factory Store," "Site Store – Rotating"	Admin only
Bank Accounts	Company bank/cash accounts used for payments and receipts	Admin/Finance Manager
Payment Methods	How money moves – bank transfer, cheque, cash, etc. (a label only, does not change which bank account is used)	Admin only
Users	Every ERP login and their role	Admin only
Fixed Assets	Company equipment/machinery – see Part 23	Admin/Finance Manager

NOT AVAILABLE

Formal Employee master records for permanent staff payroll are Not Available in the current ERP. Site labour is recorded per-project as described in Part 16, not as a company-wide HR employee master.

Sales and Customer Management

The sales journey starts the moment a prospective customer enquires and ends when their project is won and created.



Step 1 – Lead

Who: Sales. **What:** record every enquiry as a Lead – the customer's contact details, the site, and roughly what they want (e.g. "3BHK full interior, Kozhikode"). A Lead moves through statuses as it progresses: **New → Contacted → Qualified → Estimation → Quotation → Negotiation → Won** or **Lost / On Hold**.

COMMON MISTAKE TO AVOID

Do not skip creating a Lead "to save time." Every quotation and project in the ERP traces back to a Lead – skipping it breaks that trail and makes it harder for management to see where enquiries are being lost.

Step 2 – Estimation Request

Once a Lead is serious, Sales raises an Estimation Request, assigning it to an Estimator with the site details and scope.

Continue to Part 7 for costing and Part 8 for the quotation itself.

Estimation and Costing

Who: Estimator. The Estimator builds a costing against the Estimation Request, line by line – every material, every labour item, every service – each with a category, quantity, and rate.

HOW THE NUMBERS ADD UP

Quantity × Rate = the amount for each line.

The lines are grouped into

MATERIAL

,

LABOUR

,

TRANSPORT

,

INSTALLATION

, and

OTHER

cost.

Adding all groups gives the

BASE COST

.

An

OVERHEAD %

is added on top of the Base Cost.

A

PROFIT/MARKUP %

is then applied to Base Cost + Overhead to reach the

SELLING PRICE

.

Every line needs a real, positive quantity and a real, positive rate – the ERP will not accept a zero or negative quantity/rate on a costing line. Overhead % must be zero or positive. Profit % may occasionally be negative only if your business genuinely intends a loss-leader price – this is unusual and should be a deliberate decision, not a typo.

WATCH FOR DUPLICATE LINES

If you accidentally enter the same item twice with the same quantity and rate, the ERP will warn you (not block you) – check it's not a copy-paste mistake before continuing.

A costing can be revised – each revision is numbered (Version 1, 2, 3...) and the earlier version stays on record for reference; it is never deleted.

Quotations

A Quotation turns an approved costing into a customer-facing document.

- 1 **Create** the quotation from the finalised costing, choose the customer, add a validity period (days), and a discount % if any.
- 2 **Submit** it. Depending on the discount amount, it may need approval from a more senior role before it can be sent (see the Do/Don't box below).
- 3 Once approved (or auto-approved for a small discount), it is **Sent** to the customer.
- 4 Record the customer's response: **Accepted** or **Rejected** .
- 5 An accepted quotation is converted to a **Won** project (Part 9).

DISCOUNT LIMIT

A discount can never exceed 100% and can never be negative. The ERP calculates your final price as Selling Price minus the discount – a discount over 100% would mean charging the customer a negative amount, which the system correctly refuses.

Revising a Quotation

If terms change before acceptance, create a Revision. This supersedes the old version (which is kept, not deleted) with a new revision number. A revision can only change the customer-facing terms (discount, validity, prospect name, notes, terms) – it can never directly set the quotation's status to Approved, fabricate an approval, or set the final price by hand. The final price is always recalculated from the underlying costing and the (validated) discount.

DO	DON'T
Revise a quotation through the Revise action if terms genuinely change	Try to edit an Accepted quotation directly – once accepted, it cannot be revised
Let the discount-approval workflow run its course for larger discounts	Ask someone to approve their own quotation's discount – the ERP blocks self-approval where a real approval step is required

PART 9

Project Management



A project is created automatically when a quotation is won, carrying over the customer and the agreed value – or it can be created directly by Admin for internal/non-sales projects. A project status moves through **Draft → Planned → Active → On Hold / Completed → Closed**.

Assignment

Every project should have an assigned **Project Manager**. A Project Manager can only view the full financial detail of the projects assigned to them – not every project in the company.

During the project

Everything that costs money against a project – material issues, labour, expenses, purchase orders – is tagged to that project's ID, so its running cost and profitability (Selling Price minus real cost so far) is always visible.

Project Closure

CLOSED MEANS CLOSED

Once a project is Closed, ordinary users cannot post any new cost or billing against it – no material issue, no labour entry, no invoice. This protects a finished project's numbers from being changed by accident weeks or months later.

If a genuine correction is required against a closed project (a bill that arrived late, for example), an authorized role (CEO or Admin) can override the closed-project block – but only by entering a clear,

written reason. This override is recorded permanently in the audit trail (Part 30), including who did it and why.

Procurement and Purchase Orders

Requirement → Purchase Order → Approval → GRN → Supplier Bill → Payment

1 Purchase creates a Purchase Order (PO): vendor, project, materials, quantity, and rate per line.

2 Submit the PO. A small-value PO auto-approves; a larger one needs sign-off from an authorized approver, based on its total value.

3 Once approved, the PO becomes an active **Commitment** — a record that this money is earmarked, even before anything is received or billed.

4 Materials arrive → record the **Goods Receipt (GRN)**, Part 11.

5 The vendor's bill is recorded and matched, Part 12.

6 Payment is made, Part 12/24.

SEGREGATION OF DUTIES

The person who created a Purchase Order cannot also approve it. This is a deliberate control, enforced by the ERP itself — it cannot be worked around by asking nicely.

The three-way relationship

A PO, its GRN, and its Supplier Bill are always linked. You cannot receive more than what the PO ordered, and you cannot bill for more than what was genuinely received against a real PO — the ERP checks the chain every time.

A PO cannot be edited once approved. If genuinely needed, cancel the approved PO (with a reason) and raise a new one — this is a deliberate, disclosed limitation, not an oversight: amending an

approved PO's committed amounts is **NOT AVAILABLE** today.

PART 11

Goods Receipt / GRN

Who: Purchase. When materials physically arrive, record a GRN against the correct PO – the warehouse, quantity received per line, and any rejection notes.

BUSINESS POLICY

A GRN does not need a separate second-person approval step in this ERP – the receiving action itself is the final record, since the Purchase Order was already approved earlier. This is an intentional design, not a missing control.

- You cannot receive against a PO that has been cancelled.
 - You cannot receive more than the PO's ordered quantity for a line.
 - A GRN increases warehouse stock immediately and moves the PO's status toward **PartiallyReceived** or **FullyReceived**.
-

PART 12

Supplier Bills and Payments

Who: Accountant (creates), Finance Manager (approves/posts). A Supplier Bill can be raised directly against a received PO/GRN, matching quantities and rates automatically, or entered independently for non-PO expenses.

A bill moves through **Draft → Submitted → Approved → Posted**. The person who created the bill cannot also approve it.

Paying the supplier

Payment can be made directly (Finance Manager/Admin) or through the formal Payment Request maker-checker workflow (Part 24) for stronger control. See Part 22 for the GST treatment on bills.

DO NOT OVERPAY

The ERP will not let you pay more than a bill's remaining outstanding balance.

PART 13

Inventory and Materials

Every physical movement of stock is recorded as a movement of a specific quantity of a specific material, in or out of a specific warehouse/site.

MOVEMENT	EFFECT
Receipt (via GRN)	Stock increases in the receiving warehouse
Material Issue	Stock decreases; cost is charged to the project it's issued for
Material Return	Unused material returned; stock increases again
Inventory Transfer	Stock moves from one warehouse to another – no gain or loss
Inventory Adjustment	A correction after a physical count finds a real difference – requires a reason
Damage / Scrap	Material written off as unusable, with a recorded reason

IN PLAIN TERMS

If 10 sheets of plywood are issued to a project, the warehouse stock decreases by 10 sheets, and that cost is recorded against that project – visible on the project's cost so far.

Stock value is tracked using a **Moving Average** cost – each new purchase at a different price gradually shifts the average cost of what's on the shelf, rather than keeping every batch's price separate.

STOCK CANNOT GO NEGATIVE

The ERP will not let you issue more of a material than is actually in stock at that warehouse. If you're sure the stock is really there, check you've selected the correct warehouse.

PART 14

Site Material Management

Materials sent to a project site follow their own short workflow so site consumption is tracked separately from the factory warehouse.

Site Requisition



Approval



Site Issue



Site Receipt



Site Consumption

1 **Site In-Charge** raises a Site Material Requisition – what's needed at site.

2 An authorized approver (typically Finance/Purchase) approves it.

3 **Purchase** issues it from the warehouse – a Delivery Challan is generated and warehouse stock decreases.

4 **Site In-Charge** confirms receipt at site – any discrepancy between what was sent and what arrived is recorded and flagged before the material is used.

5 As material is actually used at site, it is recorded as Site Consumption, charging the real cost to the project.

ALWAYS CONFIRM RECEIPT

Do not skip the Site Material Receipt step, even if everything looks fine. Recording a discrepancy immediately (short delivery, damaged item) is much easier to resolve than discovering it weeks later.

PART 15

Job Work / Subcontracting

When Appletree's own material is sent to an outside job worker for processing (e.g. edge-banding, cutting) and expected back, this is tracked as Job Work – separate from a sale, since ownership of the material never transfers.

- **Job Work Dispatch** – material sent to the job worker, recorded against the project.
- **Job Work Return** – the processed material comes back.
- **Job Work Scrap** – genuine wastage during processing, with a disposition recorded (destroyed, sold by the job worker, or sold by Appletree).
- **Direct Dispatch from Job Worker** – material goes straight from the job worker's premises to the customer, without returning to Appletree first (only permitted where the job worker's

registration status allows it under GST rules).

BUSINESS POLICY

Job work movements never post a GL/accounting entry by themselves – Appletree's own material never stops being Appletree's own asset just because it is temporarily at a job worker's premises. A processing charge billed by the job worker is recorded as an ordinary Supplier Bill (Part 12), separately.

PART 16

Labour and Labour Costs

Site labour is recorded per project – worker name, number of days, and rate per day.

BOTH NUMBERS MUST MAKE SENSE ON THEIR OWN

Days and Rate per Day must each individually be a real, positive number. Entering something like "-5 days at -₹100/day" is rejected even though the two negatives would otherwise multiply into a positive total – the ERP checks each figure on its own, not just the final amount.

Labour cost cannot be posted against a Closed project without an authorized override (Part 9).

PART 17

Project Expenses

Any other real cost against a project that isn't a material purchase or labour entry – site transport, small tools, permits, etc. – is recorded as a Project Expense, with a category, amount, and description.

Like every other project-cost entry, this respects the closed-project rule (Part 9) and closed-period rule (Part 25).

PART 18

Customer Billing

Two ways to bill a customer exist:

- **Direct Customer Invoice** – a straightforward bill for an amount against a project.
- **Billing Milestone Invoice** – for projects billed in stages (e.g. 30% advance, 40% on installation, 30% on completion), each milestone is invoiced separately as it's reached.

Every invoice moves through the same lifecycle: **Draft → Submitted → Approved → Posted**.

STATUS	WHAT IT MEANS IN PLAIN TERMS
Draft	Created but not yet reviewed by anyone else. Can still be edited or cancelled freely.
Submitted	Sent for approval. Waiting for a second, different person to review it.
Approved	Reviewed and cleared to go final – but not yet in the accounts.
Posted	Now permanently part of the accounts. This is the customer's real invoice.

DO NOT TREAT A DRAFT AS FINAL

A Draft invoice has no accounting effect at all – it does not appear in the customer's outstanding balance, revenue, or GST reports until it is Posted.

CROSS-CHECK BEFORE BILLING

You cannot invoice one customer for a project that actually belongs to a different customer. This exact check is built into the ERP – a mismatch is rejected.

PART 19

Customer Receipts

When a customer pays, record a Customer Receipt against the specific open invoice it settles – the amount cannot exceed that invoice's remaining outstanding balance. This is called **Clearing**: the receipt is matched (cleared) against the invoice it pays off.

A **Customer Advance** (money received before any invoice exists – e.g. a booking advance) is recorded separately and adjusted against invoices as they are raised later.

The **Customer Ledger** report (Part 27) always shows a customer's real outstanding balance, based on their posted invoices minus their cleared receipts.

Credit Notes and Debit Notes

DOCUMENT	WHEN TO USE IT
Customer Credit Note	You owe the customer a reduction — e.g. a billing error, an agreed discount after invoicing, a return
Customer Debit Note	The customer owes you more — a rare correction upward on an existing invoice
Supplier Credit Note	A supplier owes Appletree a reduction — e.g. rejected/returned goods
Supplier Debit Note	Appletree owes the supplier more, or is formally claiming back an amount from them

Every CN/DN must reference the original invoice or bill it corrects — it can never be created standing alone. It can be a **partial** adjustment (part of the original amount) or a **full** adjustment (the entire amount). GST is adjusted proportionally, automatically, based on the original document's tax code.

BUSINESS POLICY

A Credit/Debit Note posts directly once created — it does not have its own separate approval step, because it always refers back to an original document that was already approved and posted.

Accounting and Journal Entries

Almost everything you do elsewhere in the ERP – an invoice, a bill, a receipt, a payment – automatically creates the correct accounting entry behind the scenes. You do not need to be an accountant to use the ERP correctly.

A **Manual Journal Entry** exists for the rare case that genuinely needs a direct accounting entry outside the normal transaction screens (e.g. an internal correction). This is normally an **Accountant/Finance Manager/Admin** function.

EVERY ENTRY MUST BALANCE

Total debit must always equal total credit. The ERP will not accept an entry that does not balance, and will not accept an entry with fewer than two lines.

The real Chart of Accounts

ACCOUNT	TYPE	WHAT IT TRACKS
Bank	Asset	Company bank/cash balance
Accounts Receivable (AR)	Asset	What customers owe Appletree
Inventory / WIP	Asset	Value of stock on hand
Accounts Payable (AP)	Liability	What Appletree owes suppliers
Customer Advance Liability	Liability	Advances received but not yet invoiced against
Output Tax Payable	Liability	GST collected from customers, owed to the government
Project Revenue	Income	Revenue earned from projects
Material Cost / Labour Cost / Site Expense	Expense	Project costs
Fixed Assets – Cost / Accumulated Depreciation	Asset	Company equipment (Part 23)
TDS Payable	Liability	Tax deducted at source on eligible supplier payments

Reversal: if a posted entry is genuinely wrong, it is never edited directly. Instead, it is **Reversed** – the ERP creates an equal and opposite entry that exactly cancels the original, and both remain

visible forever. A reason is always required. A reversal cannot itself be reversed a second time, and an entry that has already been reversed cannot be reversed again.

PART 22

GST and Tax

GST is applied through pre-set **Tax Codes**, each combining the rates that apply. Real tax codes currently configured include:

TAX CODE	RATE	USED FOR
GST5	2.5% CGST + 2.5% SGST	Intra-state, 5% GST items
GST12CS	6% CGST + 6% SGST	Intra-state, 12% GST items
GST18	9% CGST + 9% SGST	Intra-state, 18% GST items (most common)
GST28CS	14% CGST + 14% SGST	Intra-state, 28% GST items
GST12	12% IGST	Inter-state (outside Kerala) transactions

IN PLAIN TERMS

CGST + SGST are used when the customer/vendor is in the same state (Kerala to Kerala). IGST is used when the transaction crosses a state border.

On every invoice and bill, GST is calculated as: **Base Amount + Tax Amount = Gross (Total) Amount**. Tax follows through automatically to Credit/Debit Notes and Reversals, in exact proportion to the original document.

TAX CODES CANNOT BE INVENTED ON THE FLY

Only Admin can create a new Tax Code, and every rate entered must be between 0% and 100% and a real number – the ERP rejects a blank, a typo, or an impossible rate outright rather than silently treating it as 0%.

NOT VERIFIED

End-to-end certification of every individual GST rate tier (0%, 5%, 12%, 28% specifically) and of ITC (Input Tax Credit) reversal for write-offs has not been separately confirmed. The 18% rate and the overall CGST/SGST/IGST split arithmetic have been directly verified. Always have your Accountant review a GST-sensitive transaction that looks unusual.

PART 23

Fixed Assets

Register → Capitalize → Depreciate → Transfer / Dispose

1 Register the asset – name, cost, purchase date, and (if relevant) the project/location.

2 Capitalize it – set the useful life, depreciation method, and residual value, and confirm whether it was paid via bank or is still payable to a vendor.

3 Depreciate it over time, period by period.

4 Dispose it when retired/sold, recording the disposal proceeds.

RULES THAT ARE STRICTLY ENFORCED

- Cost must be a real, positive number.
- Residual value must be less than the cost and cannot be negative.
- An asset can only be capitalized once, depreciated only while Capitalized, and disposed only once – you cannot dispose the same asset twice, and you cannot depreciate or re-capitalize an asset that has already been disposed.

MANAGEMENT / ACCOUNTING NOTE

Fixed Asset capitalization currently posts to the same GL account used for general Inventory Asset value. Whether this should remain shared or be split into its own dedicated account is an open accounting policy question for Finance/Management – not a software error, and not yet decided either way.

NO SEPARATE SECOND APPROVER TODAY

The person who registers an asset can also capitalize it – there is presently no built-in second-person check for this specific step, unlike invoices and bills. If your business wants one, this is a policy decision for Management to raise with your ERP administrator.

PART 24

Payment Requests and Approvals

For stronger control over outgoing payments, use the formal Payment Request workflow instead of a direct payment.

1 Requester creates the Payment Request against a real open supplier bill, with the amount.

2 Approver (a different person) approves it.

3 Executor (a third, different person again) actually releases the payment.

THREE DIFFERENT PEOPLE

The requester cannot approve their own request, and neither the requester nor the approver can be the one who executes the payment – the ERP enforces genuine maker-checker-executor separation, not just maker-checker.

If a payment attempt fails partway for any reason, the ERP guarantees it will not accidentally create a duplicate payment if you retry – either it goes through cleanly once, or it doesn't go through at all.

Period Management

Accounting periods can be **Open** or **Closed** . Once your Finance team closes a period (e.g. after month-end accounts are finalised), ordinary postings into that period are blocked.

POSTING INTO A CLOSED PERIOD

Only a specifically authorized role can override a closed period, and only by providing a genuine written reason. This is always recorded in the audit trail.

Similarly, dates far in the future are restricted by default – a transaction dated many months ahead needs the same kind of authorized override and reason.

After-Sales / Service

The ERP includes screens for Service Requests, Service Visits, AMC (Annual Maintenance Contracts), and CAPA (Corrective/Preventive Action for recurring complaints).

ITEM	STATUSES USED
Service Ticket / Complaint	New → Assigned/Triaged → In Progress → Waiting Parts/Customer → Resolved → Closed (or Rejected)
Service Visit	Planned → Assigned → In Progress → Completed (or Cancelled)
AMC Contract	Draft → Active → Expired/Renewed (or Cancelled)
CAPA Case	Open → Analysis → Action → Verification → Closed

FEATURE AVAILABLE – COMPLETE WORKFLOW NOT VERIFIED

These After-Sales screens exist and their statuses are real, but a full start-to-finish certification of the complete after-sales workflow (every status transition, every role interaction) has not been separately completed. Use them, but have your supervisor double-check an unusual after-sales case until this is confirmed.

Reports

GROUP	REPORT	USE IT TO...
Finance	Trial Balance	Confirm every account balances – total debit equals total credit
	General Ledger	See every posted entry for a chosen account
	Balance Sheet	See the company's assets, liabilities, and equity at a point in time
	Reconciliation	Cross-check the accounts are internally consistent
	Bank Reconciliation	Match ERP bank records against the bank statement
Customer/Supplier	Customer Ledger / AR Ageing	See what each customer owes, and for how long
	Supplier Ledger / AP Ageing	See what Appletree owes each supplier, and for how long
Projects	Project Financial 360	See one project's full cost, revenue, and profitability picture
	Company Project Profitability	Compare profitability across all projects
Procurement	Purchase Vendor Report	Review purchasing activity per vendor
	Job Work Ageing	See job-work material that hasn't been returned yet, and for how long
Inventory	Stock Report / Site Material Reconciliation	Check what's on hand, where
Fixed Assets	Fixed Asset Reconciliation	Confirm asset cost, depreciation, and book value
Compliance	ITC Reversal Report	Track GST input credit reversed on written-off stock
Management	SOP Compliance Dashboard	Check adherence to key company procedures at a glance

NOT VERIFIED

A full field-by-field, row-by-row check of every export/report's exact output has not been separately certified for every report listed above (see Part 29). The underlying figures have been independently verified for the highest-priority accounting and inventory reports.

Importing Data

IMPORT	WHAT IT'S FOR	RESULT
Journal CSV	Bulk-load manual journal entries from a spreadsheet	Creates a Draft – never posts automatically. Every row is checked for a real account, project, cost centre, and tax code, and the whole batch must balance before it's accepted.
Master Data Import	Bulk-load customers, vendors, materials, etc.	Each row is validated on its own – one bad row is rejected without affecting the good rows in the same file.
Opening Balance Import	Load starting balances when first setting up the ERP	Same row-by-row safety as Master Data Import.
Bank Statement Import	Load your bank's transaction statement for reconciliation	Creates unreconciled statement lines only – never posts to the accounts by itself. You still allocate/match each line manually.

NOT VERIFIED

A complete, successful ICICI bank-statement import has not been demonstrated end-to-end with a genuine bank statement file. Use this feature, but have Finance double-check the very first real import you attempt before relying on it.

Exporting Data

Eight export types are available to authorized users (mainly Finance/Admin/CEO/Viewer, some also open to a Project Manager for their own projects):

- General Ledger (GL)
- Accounts Receivable (AR)
- Accounts Payable (AP)
- Project P&L
- Inventory
- Financial 360 (per project)
- Customer Profitability

- After-Sales Summary

EXPORT IS AVAILABLE, BUT COMPLETE FIELD-BY-FIELD EXPORT VERIFICATION IS NOT CURRENTLY CERTIFIED

for any of the eight export types above. The figures come from the same, verified underlying data as the on-screen reports, but the export file's exact formatting, column set, and edge cases have not been separately checked row-by-row.

PART 30

Audit Trail and Controls

The audit trail records who performed an action, what happened, and when it happened. It helps management investigate mistakes and maintain accountability — and it cannot be turned off or edited by a normal user.

Actions recorded include: every successful transaction, every rejected attempt (wrong permission, bad data, business rule violation), every approval, every override (with its reason), and every reversal.

YOU ARE PROTECTED TOO

If a transaction genuinely fails partway through for a technical reason, the ERP is built so that it cannot end up "half-done" in your accounts, and a safe retry cannot accidentally create a duplicate. This has been directly and repeatedly tested.

PART 31

User Roles and Permissions – Detailed

ADMIN

Full system control

Creates every master, manages users, configures the system. Approves and posts anything. The only role that can create new Users, GL Accounts, Tax Codes, and Cost/Profit Centres.

CEO

Full business authority

Same transaction powers as Admin, plus the specific Board-level actions (e.g. approving the company's Payment Approval Matrix policy) that even Admin cannot do alone.

FINANCE MANAGER

Financial approval & control

Approves, posts, reverses, clears, and pays.
Cannot create new master data (Admin does that)
but runs the day-to-day financial controls.

ACCOUNTANT

Books the numbers

Creates and submits invoices, bills, and journal entries; clears receipts. Cannot approve, post, reverse, or pay — those need a Finance Manager, CEO, or Admin.

PURCHASE

Procurement & receiving

Creates POs, records GRNs, manages vendors, handles inventory transfers, site issues, and job work dispatch. Cannot approve their own PO.

SALES

Customers & quotations

Manages leads, customers, and quotations. Only sees customers assigned to them if their account is scoped that way.

ESTIMATOR

Costing

Builds costing versions against estimation requests. Does not approve or post financial transactions.

PROJECT MANAGER

Oversight

Full read access to their own assigned projects' cost, progress, and profitability. Does not create or post transactions directly.

SITE IN-CHARGE

Site operations

Raises site material requisitions, confirms site receipts, records site consumption and labour at their site.

VIEWER

Read-only

Can see what they're given access to. Cannot create, edit, or export anything.

NOT VERIFIED

Not every possible combination of role, project, and action has been individually re-tested. The controls shown above and used throughout this handbook are the ones directly confirmed against the live system.

Common Errors and How to Fix Them

"Cannot post – project is Closed."

Why: the project has already been closed for further transactions.

What to do: confirm the transaction genuinely belongs to this project. If a real correction is needed, ask an authorized Finance/Management user to use the closed-project override, with a reason.

"Segregation of duties: you created this document and cannot also approve it."

Why: a control requires a different person to review what you created.

What to do: ask a colleague with approval rights to review it. Do not ask them to simply "click approve" without actually checking it.

"A material/customer/vendor/project with this reference does not exist."

Why: you typed or selected an ID that isn't real in the system.

What to do: re-check you selected the correct record from the dropdown/search, rather than typing a code from memory.

"Amount must be a positive number."

Why: you left a numeric field blank, entered text, or entered zero/negative where a real value is required.

What to do: re-enter a genuine number greater than zero.

"Only X available in this warehouse, requested Y."

Why: you tried to issue/transfer more stock than actually exists there.

What to do: check the correct warehouse is selected, and check the Stock Report (Part 27) for the real available quantity.

"Cannot reverse – it is itself a reversal entry."

Why: you tried to reverse an entry that was already created to reverse something else.

What to do: if the original transaction is genuinely needed again, post it again as a brand-new, separately authorized entry – do not try to "undo the undo."

Daily / Weekly / Monthly Procedures

Daily

- ☐ Check pending approvals waiting on you
- ☐ Check open purchase requirements and POs awaiting approval
- ☐ Check GRNs recorded against yesterday's deliveries
- ☐ Check supplier bills awaiting review
- ☐ Check customer invoices awaiting approval/posting
- ☐ Check customer receipts received and cleared
- ☐ Check payment requests at each stage (raised/approved/executed)
- ☐ Check project expenses and labour entered for the day
- ☐ Check material movements for anything unusual

Weekly

- ☐ Review project profitability across active projects
- ☐ Review AR (customer outstanding) and AP (supplier outstanding)
- ☐ Review inventory levels against reorder points
- ☐ Review any pending approvals that have been sitting too long
- ☐ Review any unusual inventory adjustments

Monthly

- ☐ Review the Trial Balance
- ☐ Review AR/AP ageing in detail
- ☐ Review GST figures before filing

- ☐ Review project profitability company-wide
 - ☐ Review inventory valuation
 - ☐ Review any reversals made during the month, and why
 - ☐ Review the audit trail for unusual overrides
 - ☐ Close the accounting period once everything above is confirmed
-

PART 34

Management Controls

- ☐ User access – who has which role, and is it still correct?
 - ☐ Approvals – is anything stuck waiting too long?
 - ☐ Financial postings – any unusual entries this period?
 - ☐ Reversals – how many, and are the reasons genuine?
 - ☐ Closed periods/projects – any override used, and was the reason legitimate?
 - ☐ Inventory adjustments – any pattern of repeated adjustments at one location?
 - ☐ Purchase commitments – do open POs match real expected spend?
 - ☐ Customer/supplier outstanding – any balance ageing too long?
 - ☐ Project profitability – any project trending the wrong way?
 - ☐ GST – figures reconciled before filing?
 - ☐ Audit trail – reviewed for anything unusual?
 - ☐ Data backup – has a recent backup been taken (ask your Admin)?
-

PART 35

Frequently Asked Questions

Why can't I approve my own quotation/invoice/PO?

I made a mistake on a Posted invoice – can I just edit it?

Why won't the ERP let me issue more stock than what's shown?

Can I post a transaction into last month if it's already closed?

What's the difference between Draft, Approved, and Posted?

Who do I contact if I'm locked out?

PART 36

Quick Reference Guides

1 New Customer

1. Go to Customers → New
2. Enter Name, GSTIN (if any)
3. Save

✓ Done – customer is now available for quoting/billing

2 New Vendor

1. Go to Vendors → New
2. Enter Name, GST Number, Category
3. Save

✓ Done

3 New Material

1. Go to Materials → New
2. Enter Code, Description, UOM, Standard Cost, Tax Code
3. Save

✓ Done

4 New Lead

1. Go to Leads → New
2. Enter customer contact, site, requirement
3. Save – status starts at New

✓ Done

5 Estimation

1. From the Lead, raise an Estimation Request
2. Assign an Estimator
3. Save

✓ Done – Estimator can now build costing

6 Costing

1. Open the Estimation Request
2. Add material/labour/other lines with qty & rate
3. Set Overhead % and Profit %
4. Save

✓ Done – selling price is calculated automatically

7 Quotation

1. Create Quotation from the finalised Costing
2. Choose customer, validity, discount %
3. Submit

✓ Done – approval routes automatically by discount size

8 New Project

1. Record customer's Acceptance as "Accepted"
2. Mark the quotation Won
3. Project is created automatically

✓ Done – assign a Project Manager next

9 Purchase Order

1. Go to Purchase Orders → New
2. Select vendor, project, add material lines
3. Submit

✓ Done – auto-approves if small, else routes for approval

10 GRN

1. Open the approved PO
2. Record GRN – warehouse and quantity received
3. Save

✓ Done – stock increases

11 Supplier Bill

1. Create bill against the PO/GRN, or standalone
2. Check quantity/rate match
3. Submit for approval

✓ Done

12 Supplier Payment

1. Select the approved, posted bill
2. Enter amount ($\leq$ outstanding balance)
3. Confirm payment method/bank

✓ Done

13 Material Issue

1. Select project, material, warehouse
2. Enter quantity ($\leq$ available stock)
3. Save

✓ Done – project cost updates

14 Material Return

1. Select the original issue/movement
2. Enter returned quantity
3. Save

✓ Done – stock increases again

15 Inventory Transfer

1. Select material, source and destination warehouse
2. Enter quantity
3. Save

✓ Done

16 Project Expense

1. Select project, category, amount, description
2. Save

✓ Done

17 Labour Entry

1. Select project, worker, days, rate/day
2. Both days and rate must be positive
3. Save

✓ Done

18 Billing Milestone

1. Set up milestones on the project (e.g. 30/40/30)
2. Invoice each milestone as it's reached

✓ Done

19 Customer Invoice

1. Select customer, project, amount, tax code
2. Submit → Approve → Post

✓ Done – now in the customer's real balance

20 Customer Receipt

1. Select customer and the open invoice
2. Enter amount received ($\leq$ outstanding)
3. Save

✓ Done – invoice clears fully or partially

21 Credit Note

1. Select the original invoice/bill
2. Enter the adjustment amount and reason
3. Save

✓ Done

22 Debit Note

1. Select the original invoice/bill
2. Enter the amount and reason
3. Save

✓ Done

23 Payment Request

1. Requester creates it against an open bill
2. Approver (different person) approves
3. Executor (a third person) executes

✓ Done

24 Journal Entry

1. Enter date, narration, and balanced debit/credit lines
2. Submit → Approve → Post

✓ Done

25 Fixed Asset

1. Register: name, cost, date
2. Capitalize: useful life, method, residual value
3. Depreciate each period going forward

✓ Done

26 Project Closure

1. Confirm all billing, receipts, and costs are complete
2. Set project status to Closed
3. No further ordinary postings allowed after this

✓ Done

PART 37

Known Limitations / Not Available Features

In plain business terms:

- **NOT AVAILABLE** A formal company-wide HR/payroll Employee master – labour is recorded per-project only (Part 16).
- **NOT AVAILABLE** Editing an already-approved Purchase Order's committed quantities/amounts – cancel and re-raise instead.
- **BUSINESS POLICY** GRN and Credit/Debit Notes do not have their own separate second-approval step – this is an intentional design choice, not a gap.
- **NOT VERIFIED** Complete, real-data-tested bank statement import (ICICI format) – the feature exists and is safe to try, but a fully successful real-file run has not yet been demonstrated.
- **NOT VERIFIED** Full field-by-field certification of every export file (Part 29).
- **NOT VERIFIED** Every GST rate tier and ITC reversal scenario (Part 22) – the most common rate (18%) is confirmed.
- **POLICY DECISION PENDING** Whether Fixed Asset capitalization needs its own second-approver, and whether it should use its own dedicated GL account separate from Inventory Asset (Part 23).

MANAGEMENT / IT NOTES

The ERP currently stores its data in a single data file rather than a full enterprise database. This means, technically, it does not yet have enterprise-grade crash recovery or the ability to run on more than one server at once. For Appletree's day-to-day single-office use this has not caused a problem; it is disclosed here for management awareness, not as an everyday operational concern for staff.

Final Process Checklists

Before you submit any document

- ☐ Correct customer/vendor selected?
- ☐ Correct project selected?
- ☐ Quantities and amounts are real, positive numbers?
- ☐ Correct tax code applied?
- ☐ Reason entered, where the ERP asks for one?

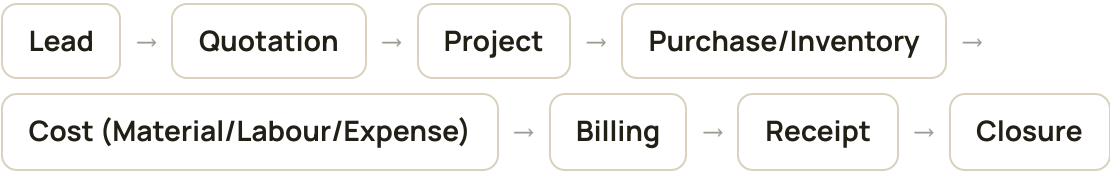
Before you approve any document

- ☐ Did you actually check the document, not just click Approve?
- ☐ Are you a genuinely different person from whoever created it?
- ☐ Does the amount/quantity look reasonable for this project?

Before month-end close

- ☐ All invoices/bills for the period Posted, not left in Draft?
- ☐ Trial Balance reviewed?
- ☐ AR/AP ageing reviewed?
- ☐ All reversals for the period explained?

A. Master Process Map



B. Role Responsibility Matrix

ROLE	MAIN RESPONSIBILITY	CAN DO	CANNOT DO
Admin	System & master data setup	Everything, incl. all masters and users	—
CEO	Business oversight	Everything, incl. Board-level policy approval	—
Finance Manager	Financial control	Approve, post, reverse, pay, clear	Create new master data
Accountant	Bookkeeping	Create, submit, clear	Approve, post, reverse, pay
Purchase	Procurement	Create/submit PO, GRN, inventory moves	Approve own PO, post financials
Sales	Customer & quotations	Create/submit leads, quotations	Approve own discount, post financials
Estimator	Costing	Build/revise costing	Approve, post financials
Project Manager	Project oversight	View assigned project detail	Create/edit/post transactions
Site In-Charge	Site operations	Requisition, receive, consume site material; record labour	Approve, post financials
Viewer	Read-only reference	View	Create, edit, export, approve

C. Master Transaction Checklist

- ☐ Lead recorded
- ☐ Costing built

- ☐ Quotation sent
- ☐ Project created
- ☐ PO raised where needed
- ☐ GRN recorded
- ☐ Bill raised
- ☐ Payment made
- ☐ Material issued
- ☐ Labour/expense recorded
- ☐ Customer invoiced
- ☐ Receipt cleared

D. Master Approval Checklist

- ☐ Quotation discount approval (where required)
- ☐ PO approval (by value tier)
- ☐ Invoice/Bill approval (Draft → Approved)
- ☐ Payment Request approval + separate execution
- ☐ Closed-project override (with reason)
- ☐ Closed-period override (with reason)

E. Master Month-End Checklist

- ☐ All drafts cleared (Posted or cancelled, none left hanging)
- ☐ Trial Balance reviewed
- ☐ AR/AP ageing reviewed
- ☐ GST reconciled
- ☐ Inventory valuation reviewed

- ☐ Reversals for the month explained
- ☐ Period closed

F. Common Error Checklist

- ☐ Closed project – need override?
- ☐ Self-approval blocked – need a different approver?
- ☐ Phantom reference – re-select from the list?
- ☐ Invalid amount – check for blank/negative/text?
- ☐ Insufficient stock – check warehouse and real quantity?

G. Known Limitations

See Part 37 in full – summarised: no formal HR/payroll master, no approved-PO amendment, no second-approver on GRN/CN/DN/Fixed-Asset-capitalization (by design or pending decision), bank-import and export-file certification pending, some GST tiers not individually re-verified.

H. Glossary

ERP

The single shared system Appletree uses to record customers, projects, purchases, stock, and accounts.

Customer / Vendor

Who Appletree sells to (Customer) and who Appletree buys from (Vendor/Supplier).

Project

One customer job, from win to closure, that all its own costs and billing are tracked against.

PO (Purchase Order)

A formal order to a vendor for materials.

GRN (Goods Receipt Note)

The record that materials from a PO have physically arrived.

Invoice / Bill

Invoice = what Appletree bills a customer. Bill = what a supplier bills Appletree.

Receipt / Payment

Receipt = money coming in from a customer. Payment = money going out to a supplier.

Journal Entry

A direct accounting entry, balanced by debit and credit.

Draft / Approved / Posted

The three stages a financial document passes through before it is final (Part 18/21).

Reversal

An equal-and-opposite entry that cancels a mistaken posted entry, keeping both on record.

Credit Note / Debit Note

A correction reducing (Credit) or increasing (Debit) an already-issued invoice or bill.

AR / AP

AR = Accounts Receivable, what customers owe you. AP = Accounts Payable, what you owe suppliers.

GST / CGST / SGST / IGST

India's Goods and Services Tax. CGST+SGST apply within the same state; IGST applies across states.

Input Tax / Output Tax

Input Tax = GST you paid on purchases. Output Tax = GST you collected on sales.

Cost Centre / Profit Centre

Ways of grouping costs or profits by department or business area.

Material Issue / Return

Sending material out to a project / bringing unused material back.

Job Work

Sending Appletree's own material to an outside party for processing, expecting it back.

Fixed Asset / Depreciation

Company-owned equipment, and the gradual reduction of its book value over its useful life.

Clearing

Matching a receipt/payment against the specific invoice/bill it settles.

Trial Balance

The report confirming every account's total debits equal total credits.

P&L

Profit and Loss — revenue minus costs over a period.

Audit Trail

The permanent record of who did what, and when.

Period

An accounting time window (e.g. a month) that can be Open or Closed to new postings.

Maker-Checker

The rule that the person who creates something cannot be the only one who approves it.

I. Document Revision History

VERSION	DATE	CHANGE
1.0	Current	First complete issue of this handbook

Appletree Interiors ERP Handbook · Version 1.0 · Final · Update only when the ERP or a business process changes.